

Standard Operating Procedures

EXP EQUITY

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1 ONBOARDING & VERIFICATION PROTOCOLS

The integrity of EXP EQUITY relies on rigorous upfront verification to prevent fraud, ensure compliance, and protect all parties.

1.1 Sponsor (Funder) Onboarding

Sponsors must be verified as legitimate entities or individuals capable of funding Escrow.

1. **Account Creation:** Sponsor inputs organizational details (Business Name, Industry, Website) or Individual capacity.
2. **Payment Gateway Linkage:** Sponsor connects a primary funding source via the Platform's integrated payment processor (e.g., Stripe).
3. **Pre-Authorization Check:** A micro-authorization (\$0.00 or \$1.00 temporary hold) is executed to verify the validity of the financial instrument.

1.2 Contractor (Graduate) Onboarding

EXP EQUITY validates contractors through a three-path verification model to ensure trait validity without creating unnecessary systemic barriers.

1. **Path A: Academic Credentialing:** Contractor uploads a transcript or diploma from an accredited institution.
2. **Path B: Industry Certification:** Contractor uploads recognized certifications (e.g., Google Professional Certificates, AWS Certifications, or State Vocational Licenses).
3. **Path C: Sandbox Proof-of-Work:** For self-taught talent without formal papers:
 - Contractor registers as a **Level 1 (Sandbox) Contractor**.
 - Access is restricted to low-risk, low-value micro-gigs (e.g., \$50).
 - Automatic account upgrade to "Verified" occurs only after the successful completion of three (3) projects with a 5-star rating.

2 PROJECT INITIATION & ESCROW LOCK

This phase transitions a requirement into a legally binding, financially secured milestone.

2.1 The Gig Drafting Process

1. **Scope Selection:** Sponsor selects one of the four Authorized Operational Categories.
2. **The Definition of Done (DoD):** Sponsor inputs a minimum of three (3) objective, binary (Yes/No) metrics that will define the completion of the project. (e.g., "Must be 1000 words," "Must be deployed to Heroku," "Must use brand hex codes").
3. **Compensation Locking:** Sponsor sets the flat-fee compensation rate for the milestone.

2.2 The Match and Contract Lock

1. **Acceptance:** A verified Contractor reviews the DoD and accepts the gig.
2. **Escrow Funding:** The Platform automatically charges the Sponsor's payment method.

3. **Status Change:** Capital is securely held in the EXP EQUITY Escrow Account. The project status shifts from [Pending] to [Active]. Neither party can unilaterally alter the DoD checklist at this point.

2.3 Market Liquidity & Project Expiry Protocol

To prevent the accumulation of unclaimed, low-value, or complex-but-underpriced projects, the Platform enforces a mandatory liquidity protocol:

1. **Market Pricing Guidance:** During the “Gig Drafting” phase, the Platform algorithm provides price-benchmarking data based on the chosen category (e.g., Coding vs. Admin) to discourage underpriced project postings.
2. **Automated Budget Boost:** If a project remains in [Pending] status for 48 hours without a bid, the Platform issues an automated request to the Sponsor to increase the project budget.
3. **Mandatory Auto-Expiry:** Any project that remains in [Pending] status for 7 consecutive calendar days without a claim will be automatically cancelled by the system.
4. **Escrow Refund:** Upon automated cancellation due to inactivity, the full Escrowed amount is immediately returned to the Sponsor’s original payment method, and the project is archived, preventing the long-term stagnation of capital.

3 EXECUTION, SUBMISSION, & QUALITY ASSURANCE

The operational phase where value is created and assessed.

3.1 Work Execution & Communication

- **Digital Gigs:** All formal communications and file transfers should occur or be documented within the Platform to provide an audit trail for potential arbitration.
- **In-Person Gigs:** Both parties must sign the digital Liability Release Waiver prior to commencement. Geolocation or a QR-code handshake may be utilized to verify physical arrival.

3.2 Submission & The 72-Hour Clock

1. **Deliverable Upload:** The Contractor submits the final assets or proof of completion via the Platform. Project status changes to [Submitted].
2. **The Review Window:** The Sponsor receives an automated notification and has exactly 72 hours to review the deliverables against the DoD.
3. **Auto-Approval Fallback:** If the Sponsor fails to act within the 72-hour window, the Platform automatically approves the work to prevent Contractor exploitation, and Escrow is released.

3.3 The Revision Loop

If the deliverables fail to meet the DoD:

1. Sponsor triggers a **Revision Request**, specifically citing which DoD items were missed.
2. The project reverts to [Active].
3. The Contractor has a maximum of two (2) revision cycles to achieve compliance. Any requests by the Sponsor outside the original DoD are flagged as unauthorized scope creep and rejected by the system.

4 SETTLEMENT & ZERO-TOUCH PAYOUT

The core structural novelty of EXP EQUITY: directing earned capital strictly toward essential survival needs.

4.1 Ledger Crediting

Upon Sponsor approval (or the expiration of the 72-hour clock), Escrow funds are transferred internally to the Contractor's Restricted Digital Wallet. This is a ledger update, not a cash transfer.

4.2 The Payout Routing Process

1. **Request Generation:** The Contractor navigates to their Wallet dashboard and selects an audited Vendor Endpoint (e.g., "Pay \$150 to my registered Water Bill").
2. **Balance Verification:** The system verifies the Contractor has sufficient Ledger Equity to cover the request.
3. **Direct B2B Transfer:** The Platform initiates an ACH, virtual card transaction, or manual check routing directly to the corporate Vendor.
4. **Receipt Generation:** Both the Contractor and the system log the transaction receipt. The Contractor's internal ledger is debited by the exact payout amount.

5 DISPUTE ARBITRATION

If the Sponsor and Contractor fundamentally disagree on whether the DoD was met after revisions, the project enters [Disputed] status.

5.1 Arbitration Freeze

1. Escrow funds are frozen.
2. Both parties have 48 hours to submit their final evidence (communications, screenshots, code files) to the Platform Admin.

5.2 Admin Adjudication

The Admin reviews the evidence strictly against the initial Definition of Done (DoD).

- **Contractor Fails DoD:** Funds are refunded to the Sponsor. Contractor receives a Strike on their profile.
- **Sponsor Scope Creep / Unfair Rejection:** Funds are forcibly released from Escrow into the Contractor's Wallet.

6 THE EQUITY CAPTURE

Following successful settlement, the Platform solidifies the Contractor's career momentum.

1. **Automated Endorsement:** The Sponsor is prompted to leave a 1-to-5 star rating and a brief written endorsement.
2. **Portfolio Verification:** The completed project is anonymized (financials hidden) and added to the Contractor's public EXP EQUITY portfolio, proving they have executed commercial-grade work for real corporate entities.